PSS ACCEPTANCE 360

P03 — Target Operating Model & Service Responsibility Matrix

Proposed operating, service-management, governance and control model

19 October 2026 | Version 1.0 | Pre-appointment design | Confidential discussion draft

DECISION POSITION

Advance a bank-sponsored, PSS-operated merchant evidence and reconciliation service into feasibility and formal role validation. No production, funds movement, contract, vendor procurement or pilot approval is implied by this draft.

Document control

Field	Control position
Document reference	PSS-A360-P03-001; candidate target operating model
Sponsor / intended reviewer	Future authorised PSS Research, Product & Business Development lead; CEO / ExCo
Accountability	Proposed only. No named PSS unit, bank or partner has accepted a duty in this paper.
Dependencies	S01, S02, S03, V02–V05, P01 v1.0 and P02 v1.0
Evidence basis	Earlier project drafts plus public regulator and standards sources listed in Annex B
Access boundary	No PSS internal system access, contracts, personnel interviews or bank operational data
Document status	PRE-ACCESS DESIGN HYPOTHESIS — institutional verification required

Executive decision summary

The proposed first service is not a payment rail, a bank ledger, an acquiring licence substitute or a merchant funds custodian. It is a bank-scoped operating utility that receives only authorised payment-status and related evidence, reconciles records, organises exceptions, supports service teams and records traceable outcomes. CONNECT supplies governed adapters; OPERATE supplies evidence, matching and case workflows. ACCEPT is conditional; GROW and agents are deferred.

OPERATING RULE

A payment authorisation, operational observation, reconciliation match and final settlement are different events and proofs. Unknown must remain unknown; no PSS operational user can manufacture settlement, credit a customer, approve a refund or alter bank accounting merely by changing a case status.

1. Purpose, scope and explicit exclusions

Purpose: define service ownership, inter-organisational processes, staffing assumptions, RACI assignments, service controls, complaint routing, escalation, reporting and readiness tests for a minimum OPERATE + CONNECT deployment.

In candidate MVP	Only after proof / separately authorised	Excluded from MVP
Event ingestion; source-backend status evidence; bank-scoped portal	PSS Pay event feed; card/QR/wallet channels with actual rights	New merchant acquisition rail or national scheme duplication
Reconciliation cases; ageing; read-only investigations	Bank-authorised refund/reversal initiation if separately assessed	Unilateral settlement, write-offs, credits, KYC and customer-money custody

In candidate MVP	Only after proof / separately authorised	Excluded from MVP
Audit, observability, incident case handling, billing evidence	Merchant-facing notifications under bank consent and contract	Credit scoring, shared cash agents and merchant-data monetisation

2. Institutional roles and legal duty boundaries

Role code	Proposed function and boundary
Bank merchant/acquiring lead (B-M)	Merchant agreement, service proposition, onboarding decisions, customer relationship, remedy and approval authority under applicable bank contract.
Bank operations (B-O)	Daily merchant support, disputed payment intake, bank system verification, operational cases and merchant communications.
Bank finance/settlement (B-F)	Bank ledger, settlement confirmation, reconciliation policy, suspense, value date and financial adjustments.
PSS product/commercial (P-P)	Contracted service design, release scope, pricing proposal, bank relationship and product change governance.
PSS operations/service (P-O)	Operational evidence monitoring, matching services, assigned exceptions, support handoff and PSS service desk.
PSS technology/SRE (P-T)	Approved interface engineering, infrastructure, deployment, telemetry, technical incident recovery and access implementation.
PSS risk/legal/security (P-R)	Independent controls, security and privacy role mapping, licensed-operator duties, material incident assessment and approval challenge.
External rail/scheme/vendor (X)	Own infrastructure and rule-bound activity under relevant membership, licences and agreements; not automatically a PSS subcontractor.
Merchant (M)	Provides required truthful records, raises support queries and acts only on authoritative payment confirmations.
Regulator (NBE)	External supervisor and legal authority, not an operational project approver or an automatic party to PSS support cases.

The matrix is not legal advice. The bank may be accountable for its acquiring and banking obligations, while PSS remains accountable for every licence, security, privacy, outsourcing, contractual or processing obligation applicable to its own services. A signed contract and counsel-approved responsibility schedule must resolve duty overlaps.

3. Operating governance structure

Forum / owner	Cadence (proposal)	Authority / outputs
ExCo / delegated sponsor	At each investment gate	Research authority, budget ceiling, production and scale approval; no automatic gate progression
Programme Steering / PSS product	Monthly during study; then per agreement	Issue log, design trade-offs, risks, customer evidence, scope and gated decisions
Joint Bank–PSS Service Review	Weekly during authorised pilot; later monthly	SLA scorecard, outstanding exceptions, escalations, commercial usage disputes
Operational Control Desk / PSS Ops	Daily on active service days	Reconciliation completeness, stale feeds, unresolved item ageing, handover log
Incident command	Per severity, when triggered	Containment, bank notification, timeline, root cause, recovery validation
Finance & Settlement Forum / bank finance	By clearing/settlement calendar	Settlement attestations, ledger owner actions, aged suspenses and break ownership
Independent Risk/Legal Checkpoint	Before critical changes and live pilots	Regulatory, data, security, contractual and consumer-protection controls

4. Operating process inventory and end-to-end service journeys

ID	Process	Lead	Required proof
OP01	Bank contract / service entitlement	P-P	Commercial terms, role schedule and access scope reviewed

ID	Process	Lead	Required proof
OP02	Merchant KYC and acquiring approval	B-M	Bank evidence only; no PSS approval substitution
OP03	Service provision / tenant activation	P-O	Bank-approved token, entitlement approval, maker-checker
OP04	Adapter on-boarding / conformance	P-T	Source contract, synthetic testing, bank/rail sign-off
OP05	Receive and validate payment evidence	P-T	Authenticate feed, dedupe, quarantine anomalies
OP06	Maintain source-backed payment status	P-O	Ambiguous outcome visible; no optimism
OP07	Reconcile operational and bank files	P-O	Deterministic match; unresolved exception open
OP08	Bank financial confirmation / settlement	B-F	Only authoritative bank/settlement source can attest finality
OP09	Exception case investigation	P-O	Assigned owner, evidence retention, time clock
OP10	Merchant complaint and remedy	B-O	Bank/customer-provider contract determines redress
OP11	Reversal/refund status observation	P-O	Bank initiates/authorises remedy; PSS only observes and supports
OP12	Access certification and periodic review	P-R	SoD, least privilege, logs, timely access removal
OP13	Incident response and source quarantine	P-T	Isolate, preserve audit evidence, notify bank and PSS duty teams
OP14	Backup/DR and recovery attestation	P-T	Validated restore, failover, consistency and bank reconciliation
OP15	Change and release management	P-T	Test evidence, approvals, rollback, version map
OP16	Service metering and invoice challenge	P-P	Reproducible charge basis, dispute window agreed
OP17	Privacy retention / DS rights routing	P-R	Controller–processor schedule and lawful data handling
OP18	Termination / bank tenant offboarding	P-P	Exit, records, retention, deletion and access removal

5. Operational workflows and case lifecycle

5.1 Merchant onboarding and service activation

- Bank acquires the merchant, performs account/KYC/risk work and authorises a merchant-service entitlement. PSS does not approve bank KYC.
- PSS checks the signed service scope, tenant and merchant-reference uniqueness; a maker requests and an independent checker authorises service activation.
- Bank and PSS validate approved channels, merchant support pathway and first-event conformance. Access is time-bound, auditable and deactivated on termination.

5.2 Payment observation, matching and exception handling

- Source sends an authorised event; CONNECT authenticates, checks idempotency and retains provenance with a bank-specific correlation identifier.
- OPERATE projects an operational payment state while preserving original source observations. Unknown/conflicting results create a visible exception.
- Reconciliation uses bank-approved cut-offs, matching tolerances and documentary bank/rail evidence; no auto-write-off or settlement inference.
- The named case owner investigates, records bank confirmation and closes only within permitted authority; correction events reopen affected cases.

5.3 Merchant disputes, complaints and remedies

- Merchant contacts the agreed bank/financial provider front line. A PSS desk can provide technical evidence under tenant-specific access, but does not promise compensation.
- Every handoff contains a case ID, timestamp, masked reference, expected next action, owning institution and response clock.
- Bank/provider or scheme authority decides refund, chargeback, reversal or account adjustment; PSS records confirmation, not unilateral financial remedy.
- Complaint response, appeal and reporting periods must be separately validated by Legal and incorporated into bank contract and approved procedures.

5.4 Incident to recovery

- Detect stale feed, data leak, tenant crossover, status conflict, payment channel loss or material mismatch; classify based on documented criteria.
- Freeze affected tenant/interface or customer message path proportionately; keep unrelated banks working where safe.
- Preserve immutable evidence; coordinate PSS operator obligations and bank customer communication; follow legally required notice clocks once verified.
- Restore through approved change, replay read-only ingestion using checkpoints, reconcile both directions, and obtain independent recovery sign-off.

6. Responsibility decision matrix — selected critical activities

Legend: A = one proposed accountable party per row, R = responsible executor, C = consulted, I = informed, – = no assigned execution role. This is a planning model, not a signed duty allocation. The 36-line working matrix in the companion workbook is the controlled detailed record.

Activity	B-M	B-O	B-F	P-P	P-O	P-T	P-R	X
Bank merchant KYC	A	R	I	I	I	I	C	–
PSS tenant provisioning	C	C	I	A	R	R	C	–
Bank-finance settlement attestation	I	C	A	I	C	I	C	C
PSS reconciliation runs	I	C	C	I	A	R	C	C
Bank customer remedy decision	A	R	C	I	C	–	C	C
PSS technical incident containment	I	C	I	I	C	A	C	R
PSS privacy and licence interpretation	C	C	I	I	C	R	A	C
PSS service invoice calculation	C	I	C	A	R	I	C	–

7. Service model, SLA/OLA and hours of operation

Do not use invented production guarantees. Candidate measures below are negotiation subjects only; each needs an actual PSS performance baseline, bank impact assessment, service cost and incident obligations. External rail performance is dependent on its own contract.

Service / metric	Measurement and trigger	Initial position
Source-event freshness	Elapsed source event time to PSS ingestion; segregate by bank and channel	Threshold TBD by bank/channel
Evidence completeness	Received expected events / source expected events; unknown denominator flagged	Threshold TBD
Reconciliation completeness	Bank-approved matched items / eligible period items; unresolved categorised	Threshold TBD
Exception backlog and ageing	Open P1/P2 exception items by age, source and owner	Action threshold TBD
Portal availability	Approved service windows, maintenance exclusions and bank tenancy	SLA target TBD after load tests
Incident first response	Time from validated alert to acknowledgement by duty owner	Class-specific target TBD
Recoverability	Restore point and time; proof via documented failover and reconciliation	RPO/RTO TBD after architecture
Complaint handoff	Bank acceptance of routed evidence, not time to credit customer	Contractual OLA TBD
Data request fulfillment	Lawful data request response after verification	Legal-defined clock TBD
Commercial metering	Reproducibility and signed bank usage extracts	Dispute mechanism TBD

CONSUMER PROTECTION CONTEXT

The NBE public complaint page states that a consumer may escalate after provider non-response or unresolved matter under its stated ten-business-day process. This is NOT an automatically applicable PSS incident SLA; bank/provider duties and exact binding directive terms require Legal review.

8. Incident severity, authority and communications

Class	Illustrative triggers (not official classification)	Response / decision owner
SEV-1 Critical	Cross-bank data exposure; systemic integrity compromise; source-status falsely shown as final for many users	PSS incident commander for PSS infrastructure; bank and compliance teams jointly assess duties and consumer impact
SEV-2 High	Single-bank outage; major reconciliation breaks;	PSS service manager + bank incident liaison;

Class	Illustrative triggers (not official classification)	Response / decision owner
	merchant impact with constrained workaround	bank manages its customers
SEV-3 Moderate	Limited source delay or controlled defect with workaround	PSS support/engineering with bank case assignment
SEV-4 Low	Non-financial cosmetic/low-risk reporting issue	Product/support backlog with planned fix

Authority: incident severity triggers must be approved by PSS Risk/CISO and the bank. Security incident notifications and regulatory filing timelines cannot be invented in this document; Legal must map binding requirements by actor and incident type.

9. Controls, access, evidence and segregation of duties

- One bank-scoped tenant across data, search, case logs, backups, metrics, disaster recovery exports and usage metering; cross-bank joins prohibited except independently justified lawful reporting.
- Distinct roles: bank economic buyer, bank merchant operator, bank finance, PSS analyst, PSS investigator, PSS engineering, platform administrator, PSS read-only auditor.
- Dual control for manual case overrides, merchant activation, production configuration, mapping-rule changes and bulk data export. No self-approval.
- Logs are append-only with clock-source annotation, event hashes and protected retention; operational state changes cannot replace source event history.
- Minimise personally identifiable and card data; avoid PAN, PIN, secrets, account credentials in application support logs.
- Financial suspense, settlement proof and accounting entries belong to the bank/competent provider, not the PSS operational evidence store.
- For outsourcing and data transfers, Legal/CISO must map local data location, purpose, controller–processor roles and current legal restrictions before deployment.

10. People, capacity and support operating model

The following are functions, not a hiring or cost plan. PSS existing personnel and outsourced vendor allocation are unverified. Baseline staffing will be established in F05 and S03 after role shadowing and operational demand observation.

Function	Coverage & workload driver	Evidence before staffing
PSS service manager	Bank portfolio, SLAs, escalation and change forums	Actual support calendar, multi-bank account load
PSS reconciliation analyst	Daily file cut-offs, open exceptions and matching rules	Case arrivals, handle-time distribution, automation rate
PSS support liaison	Bank tickets and merchant operational queries	Ticket counts, channel commitments, bank handoff times
Integration/SRE	Adapters, observability, security patches, DR, change controls	Integration inventory, MTTR, automation, vendor support
CISO/Risk/Compliance	Access reviews, risk exceptions, incident classification, DPIA	Control scope, regulatory obligations, review cadence
Commercial/Finance	Usage metering, bank invoice terms and disputes	Contract pricing and approved metering definitions

11. Outsourcing, vendor and service chain governance

- Identify all critical vendors, subcontractors, software licences, scheme participants and national rail dependencies; inspect existing PSS contracts before selection.
- Execute explicit bank–PSS and PSS–vendor responsibility schedules covering incident, audit, support, data, exit, confidentiality, intellectual property and regulator access where required.

- For PSS Trading, independently assess related-party procurement, IP ownership, vendor performance, service prices and conflict-of-interest controls; do not assume automatic award.
- Third-party rail availability cannot be presented as a PSS-controlled SLA without underpinning agreements and compensating architecture.
- Continuity and exit plans must permit complete bank record return, lawful retention, revocation of permissions and reconciliation of the final accepted events.

12. Operating risk and control register — priority examples

Risk	Control owner	Minimum acceptance evidence
Incorrect confirmed-payment message	PSS Ops + bank	Conflict/timeout negative-path test; customer copy approval
Cross-tenant disclosure	PSS Risk / Technology	Access policy and isolation tests incl. backup/exports
Unreconciled source drift	PSS Ops / Bank Finance	Source totals, matching controls, aging and sign-off
Unlawful data processing	PSS Legal / bank data owner	Data inventory, lawful basis, processor roles, DPIA
Unauthorized financial remediation	Bank Finance / PSS access owner	Proof PSS cannot post/refund/settle
Supplier outage / contract dependency	PSS Technology / Procurement	Dependency RTO test, supplier support and exit clause
Unpriced support burden	PSS Finance / Product	Bank ROI and PSS bottom-up unit cost

13. Service governance KPIs and reporting

KPI family	Indicative report	Owner
Reliability	Feed delay percentiles; data availability; case downtime	PSS Tech
Integrity	Duplicates; conflicting outcomes; quarantined events; resolved indeterminates	PSS Ops
Reconciliation	Items eligible, matched, aged unresolved, confirmed settlement evidence	PSS Ops + Bank Finance
Customer service	Handoff time; bank response; merchant complaint category; reopens	Bank Ops
Security/privacy	Privilege exceptions; tenant isolation tests; incidents; data requests	PSS Risk/CISO
Economics	Support cost/case; active bank/merchant; contracted revenues; invoice disputes	PSS Finance / Product

All metrics require source, definition, denominator, bank segmentation, data freshness and independent review. A low complaint count could reflect inaccessible channels rather than good experience.

14. Implementation readiness and sign-offs

Gate	Mandatory items to complete	Approval / stop condition
R0 — Design readiness	Signed draft bank service scope; source contract; technical and process owner mapping; legal and security review	No R0: no access to live bank/PSS data
R1 — Synthetic demonstration	Read-only canonical event test, duplicate/conflict/reversal paths, bank tenant boundary proof	No R1: no integration implementation
R2 — Restricted integration pilot readiness	Live licence/certification confirmation; bank–PSS roles; DPIA; support roster; DR test; breach/complaint workflows; cost ceiling	No R2: no production exposure or live merchant messages
R3 — Pilot go-live decision	ExCo explicit approval and responsible bank sign-offs; success/stop metrics; rollback and consumer notice plan	No R3: no live pilot
R4 — Pilot exit / scale	Independent observed security, service, bank ROI, PSS unit cost and complaint evidence	No R4: no scale or new geography

15. Before/after joining PSS — execution notebook

Before appointment / using public and synthetic material	After appointment AND authorisation
Draft operating journeys, support scripts and a neutral bank/merchant handoff design	Interview operations, bank finance, service desk and existing PSS management owners
Map proposed RACI, controls and event/case schemas against P01/P02	Read current licences, bank/vendor agreements and actual SOPs; obtain legal positions
Prepare synthetic exercises for timeouts, duplicates, reversal, settlement mismatch and outages	Observe real exception cases where authorised and lawful; measure frequency and effort
Prepare questions, scoring rules and unresolved decision register	Negotiate actual SLAs, ownership, staffing, escalation and customer contracts
Keep empty acceptance and sign-off fields; make no product claim	Secure functional/independent sign-offs; refresh budget and gates

16. Executive recommendation and next document

Disposition: CONDITIONALLY SOUND AS A RESEARCH DESIGN. Operate + Connect is a plausible bank-sponsored operating construct only if banks demonstrate an operational cost/service gap, PSS proves suitable existing capabilities, legal duties are agreed, negative-path tests pass, and the bank plus PSS economics are positive under a downside case. Maintain PSS Pay-led, partner-led and no-investment alternatives. Approve no live pilot, roll-out, bank contract or specific staffing levels on this P03 paper.

Next controlled document: P04 — Build–Buy–Partner, Vendor and Contracting Assessment. Its sourcing scenarios must use this service chain/RACI baseline while awaiting authorised internal verification.

Annex A. Companion workbook map

The Excel companion provides: Dashboard; RACI; Operating Processes; SLA & OLA; Incident Matrix; Controls; KPI Dictionary; Staffing; Handoffs; Open Decisions; Evidence Requests; External Sources. All draft tasks remain unvalidated and no legal or organisational approvals are represented as received.

Annex B. Public sources and internal baseline references

[EXT-01] NBE, Draft NDPS 2026–2030 (still labelled draft). https://nbe.gov.et/ndps/

[EXT-02] NBE, Payment Instrument Issuers/System Operators register. https://nbe.gov.et/payment-instrument-issuers-system-operators/

[EXT-03] NBE Financial Consumer Protection and Education, complaint guidance. https://nbe.gov.et/fcpe/complaint/

[EXT-04] Ethiopian Ministry of Justice, Personal Data Protection Proclamation No. 1321/2024. https://justice.gov.et/en/law/personal-data-protection-proclamation/

[EXT-05] PCI SSC, Mobile Payments on COTS. https://www.pcisecuritystandards.org/standards/mobile-payments-on-cots-mpoc/

[INT-01] P01 Product Requirements v1.0, 19 October 2026 — design hypothesis, not approved.

[INT-02] P02 Solution Architecture v1.0, 19 October 2026 — read/event-ingestion candidate, not implemented.

[INT-03] S01/S02/S03/V02–V05 — pre-appointment research corpus, not PSS internal verification.

Annex C. Record of required functional sign-offs

Function / signatory	Current state	Required verification
PSS Product / Commercial	Not obtained	Customer/business scope, funding and bank proposition
PSS Payments Operations	Not obtained	Service desk, exceptions, reconciliation, case SLAs
PSS Technology / Architecture	Not obtained	Actual integrations, deployment, DR and capacity
PSS CISO / Risk	Not obtained	Access/tenant separation, incident and control approval
PSS Legal / Compliance	Not obtained	Licence, data rights, contractual duty and complaint schedule
PSS Finance / CFO	Not obtained	Unit economics, staffing cost, service tariffs and budget
Sponsoring bank operations/finance	Not obtained	Acquirer/merchant duties, settlement and customer remedy

Sign-off record — blank pending authorised PSS review

Review body	Reviewer / official capacity	Signature / date / version
Product and Bank Commercial	Pending designation	Not signed
Bank Acquiring / Finance	Pending bank designation	Not signed
Technology / SRE / Architecture	Pending designation	Not signed
Payments Operations	Pending designation	Not signed
CISO / Risk / Data protection	Pending designation	Not signed
Legal / Compliance	Pending designation	Not signed
Finance / CFO	Pending designation	Not signed

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